

Recognising How a Text is Presented

Presentational features help the reader understand the text

- 1) Some texts use things like **headings**, **bullet points** and **colour**.
- 2) These are called **presentational features**, **layout features** or **organisational devices**.
- 3) They help make the text **easier to understand**, and make its **purpose clearer**.

Headlines tell you what an article is about

- 1) They are always **bigger** than all the other words and are at the **top** of the page.
- 2) They try to **grab** the reader's **attention** and get them to read the article.
- 3) The **tone** of the headline can give you a clue about the **mood** of the **article**.

Four Die in Brighton House Fire

This headline is serious. It only tells you what the article is about.

Electric Cars Spark Sales

This headline is humorous. 'Spark' could mean a spark of electricity or something that starts off the sales.

Subheadings, columns and text boxes break up text

Newspapers and leaflets use **columns**, **subheadings** and **text boxes** to make things **clear**.

Headline → **Electric cars spark sales**

By *Sam Jones*

Local retailers of electric cars have seen a 20% rise in the number of female drivers choosing to buy electric cars. Motoring experts believe this is due to rising petrol costs and advertising aimed at women.

Mixed opinions among experts

The electric car has caused great debate across the motoring industry. Some experts claimed that the electric car would never catch on. Others argued that there was a place for these vehicles in our new 'greener' society.

Highly recommended

This reporter spoke to Mrs Patel, who recently bought an electric car. She is a very happy customer and recommends the new model to all her friends. "I have nothing bad to say about this car," Mrs Patel told me. "It was a brilliant purchase."

Share your thoughts on today's news headlines

Have you or anyone you know bought an electric car? What do you think about the sudden increase in electric car purchases? Have your say on our website — visit www.azmail.co.uk today.

Subheadings divide up the text and explain what each part is about.

Text boxes separate information from the rest of the text.

Columns break up the text so that it's easier to read.

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Paragraphs divide text up into chunks

- 1) When writers introduce a **new subject** or **idea**, they start a **new paragraph**.
- 2) This helps give their writing a **structure** and makes it easier to **understand**.

Caroline, the main character, is the best thing about this book.
By the end she almost feels like a friend.

However, the book is let down by its plot. It is so ridiculous
that it could have been thought up by a child.

A new paragraph starts here. This shows where the part about Caroline ends and the part about the plot begins.

Bullet points and numbered lists divide up texts

- 1) **Bullet points** separate information into **short bits of text** so it's **easier to read**.
- 2) **Numbered lists** can be used instead of bullet points.
- 3) This is usually for things that are **in an order**, like a set of **instructions**.

To make a complaint, contact us by:

- Emailing our customer service team
- Calling our freephone helpline

Bullet points separate each piece of information. This makes the writing clear.

Sometimes parts of the text will be in a table or a footnote

- 1) In a **table**, use the **column headings** to help you find the information.

EXAMPLE:

- 1) What was the rabbit population in winter 1950?

Local Rabbit Population

Year	Spring	Summer	Autumn	Winter
1850	61	167	59	23
1950	112	237	104	52

Rows go across the table.

Columns go down the table.

Go to the row for 1950. Look along this row until you get to the column for Winter. The answer is 52.

- 2) **Footnotes** link to text at the **bottom** of the page.
- 3) They are usually shown by **small numbers**, but can also be shown by **symbols**, e.g. asterisks (*).
- 4) They make texts **easier** to understand by adding information without **interrupting** the main text.

Every year, over 5% of the plastic we use ends up in the oceans.¹

¹ If you weighed all this plastic it would weigh about the same as three million elephants.

This means that there is extra information about this sentence.

Look for the 1 in the footnotes to find the information.

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Fonts help set the tone of a text

- 1) A text's **font** gives you a clue about what **kind** of text it is.
- 2) **Serious, formal** fonts are for **serious, formal** texts.
- 3) **Cartoony, childish** fonts are for **light-hearted** texts or texts for **children**.

 **Lonely Hearts** 

Ben, 23 — Lancaster lad, born and bred.
Looking for a girl of similar age who enjoys cycling.

Amy, 32 — YOUNG-AT-HEART CLUBBER seeks man
aged 26-40 in London area to party the night away with.

The colour red is connected with love. The handwriting font makes it seem more personal.

The bold font helps divide the text up.

Capital letters can be used to emphasise key points.

Colour affects how you read a text

- 1) The **colour** of a **text**, or its **background**, creates an effect on the reader.
- 2) **Bright colours** make text look more **fun**.
- 3) **Dark colours** create a **serious mood** suitable for more **formal** texts.

Graphics and captions help you understand a text

- 1) A **graphic** is an **image, diagram** or **chart**.
- 2) It gives you **extra information** about the text.

There's more about images on p.20.

Can Graffiti Ever Be Considered Art?

Graffiti has been around for many years, and it is usually dismissed as simple vandalism. However, in recent months there has been growing pressure from the art community to recognise it as its own art form.



Graffiti on a wall in Brixton

The graphic shows the type of graffiti the text is talking about.

A caption is a bit of text that tells you more about the graphic.

Practice Questions

Read the text below, and then answer the questions underneath.

Children's Party Games

by Jesse Gallagher

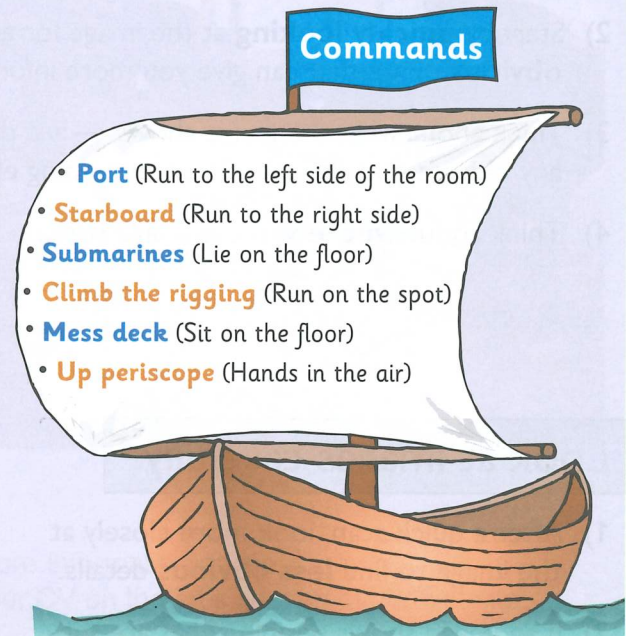
Port and Starboard

Read a command from the list on the right (or any command of your own), and tell the children to do the appropriate action. After a while, start removing the last child to do the action, until only one is left. This child is the winner.

Pass the Parcel

Wrap a present in about 10 layers of wrapping paper.¹ Play some music. Everyone sits in a circle and passes the parcel from one person to the next. When the music stops, the person holding the parcel removes ONE layer of wrapping. Repeat until the last layer has been removed. The winner keeps the present.

¹ You could try putting sweets or dares between each layer of the wrapping paper.



1) The **main** purpose of this text is to:

- | | |
|--|--|
| a) Tell children how to have fun | c) Describe how to throw a kid's party |
| b) Teach the rules of 'Port and Starboard' | d) Give ideas for party games to play |

2) Give **one** presentational feature that shows that the article is light-hearted.

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3) List **two** ways the article has been presented and say how they help the reader to understand the article better.

a) Presentational feature:

This helps the reader's understanding because:

.....

b) Presentational feature:

This helps the reader's understanding because:

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